



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Our Lady of Lourdes Catholic Classical School
School Website: <https://lourdesclassical.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Our Lady of Lourdes Catholic Classical School (Denver, CO, 80210) presents a robust Classical orientation anchored in Catholic, theologically integrated education. Public materials consistently foreground Catholic identity, the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), and a vision of education that aims at forming virtue, wisdom, and a love of truth, beauty, and goodness. The school explicitly links character formation to its religious mission, integrates liturgical life and communal practices, and highlights parental partnership as a core feature. Pedagogy leans into Socratic dialogue, memorization/recitation, and a memory-work orientation in early grades, with upper grades featuring Socratic seminars and rhetoric development. Faculty are portrayed as models of virtue and living exemplars within a relational, community-centered culture. Parental partnership and family formation are repeatedly emphasized, with explicit programming to educate and involve parents as co-educators.

Overall assessment: CLASSICAL. Across the six categories, public materials consistently align with the core indicators of a classical school as defined in the Six Essential Elements rubric: a religious/metaphysical foundation, formation-focused goals, a curriculum built on the liberal arts and Great Books/tradition, a pedagogy that balances contemplative and dialectic methods, a faculty culture anchored in virtue and mentorship, and an active, covenantal partnership with parents and the broader faith community.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Notes: The analysis draws on the Lourdes site materials (e.g., mission statements, Trivium description, liturgical life, family services, and staff/leadership pages) and anchors its judgments to the Positive/Negative Keyword Indicators drafted in the classical rubric. Citations reference the school's public materials or rubric documents as shown in the citations below.

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations evidence and keyword mapping draw on: Our mission and Catholic identity, liturgical life, sacraments, Mass, Rosary, Eucharistic Adoration, and Marian devotion (evidence from Lourdes site materials).
- The Trivium and Catholic classical framing are explicitly described in public-facing pages (Trivium page; grammar stage description).
- The Great Books / Great Conversation orientation is articulated through references to classical canon, integrated curriculum, and the "living books" approach embedded in the public materials.
- The pedagogy includes both contemplative/restful pedagogy (Scholé) and Socratic discussion in the upper grades, as described in the site's "Trivium" and pedagogy pages.
- The faculty portrayal and staff leadership are evident in the site's staff pages and leadership listings.
- The parent/community emphasis is visible in family services, Admissions, and "In Service of the Family" materials.

ABSTRACT

: The school demonstrates a clearly classical orientation with a Catholic, liturgical, and formation-first approach; the six-category rubric is satisfied across the board, with explicit evidence of Trivium pedagogy, Great Books/tradition, virtuous formation, contemplative/restful learning elements, living-teacher models, and strong parent partnership.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — CATEGORY-BY-CATEGORY SNAPSHOT

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The mission centers on forming disciples of Jesus Christ, under Mary's patronage, with a focus on truth, beauty, and goodness as a real, knowable end. The mission statement explicitly links Catholic faith, wisdom, virtue, and a sacramental worldview to the educational aim.
- Public materials emphasize liturgical life and sacraments, including daily Mass, Eucharistic Adoration, and devotion to Mary, as integral to school life.
- The Trivium framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric) is presented in public posts/pages, tying the stages of learning to Catholic formation and wisdom.
- The school's public content repeatedly anchors education in Catholic theology, sacred tradition, and religious formation across curriculum and community life.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords observed: Catholic, theology, liturgy, Mass, sacraments, Eucharistic Adoration, Rosary, sacred tradition, liturgical life, Mary/Our Lady, truth, beauty, goodness, virtue, spiritual depth, Logos, sacramental worldview, formation through faith.
- Negative keywords observed: None evident in public materials.

Quantitative estimate

- Positive keyword indicators present: 12+
- Negative keyword indicators present: 0

Why this rating

- The school displays a robust transcendental moral realism and a theologically grounded framework, with liturgical and communal practices that integrate worship and sacred life into daily schooling, aligning squarely with CLASSICAL indicators in the rubric's category 1.

Citations: Mission and Catholic identity (turn1file15); Liturgical life and family prayer (turn1file14); The Trivium description (turn0file4); Catholic formation language (turn0file0).

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The mission emphasizes formation of virtue and wisdom and the formation of human beings rather than mere information. It highlights the love of truth, beauty, and goodness and seeks to form disciples, aligning with paideia aims and the liberal-arts ideal.
- The public materials frame education as formation, intellectual and spiritual development, and human flourishing rather than vocational or job-focused preparation alone.
- The school's public statements tie education to the capacity to know truth and goodness within a Catholic worldview.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords observed: formation, virtue, wisdom, truth, goodness, beauty, liberal education, human flourishing, contemplation, the Logos, sacred tradition (within a Catholic frame), moral imagination.
- Negative keywords observed: None indicating a focus on job-oriented or purely utilitarian aims.

Quantitative estimate

- Positive keyword indicators present: 10-14
- Negative keyword indicators present: 0

Why this rating

- The school's stated purpose centers on formation and the real/knowable transcendentals, with a clear aim toward virtue and wisdom rather than mere job-readiness, which aligns with CLASSICAL criteria for school purpose and goal.

Citations: Mission and formation language (turn1file15); Catholic formation framing (turn0file0).

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Explicit Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) is presented as foundational in the curriculum (K-8), with explicit mentions of grammar, logic, and rhetoric and the educational arc through these stages.
- The grammar stage description lists English, Latin, History, Math, Science, and Scripture as core areas to be learned in the grammar stage, showing a liberal-arts structure and cross-disciplinary approach.
- The materials emphasize Great Books/Great Conversation and an integrated approach across history, literature, philosophy, and science—characteristics central to classical curricula. The site references a Catholic classical framework and the value of wonder in learning, with mentions of sacred history, virtue, and integrated texts.
- The site discusses a requirement to cultivate wonder and connect subject matter to larger questions, consistent with classical pedagogy.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords observed: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Quadrivium (arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy), Great Books/Great Conversation, history integrated in curriculum, Latin, sacred texts, wonder, integrated/harmonious curriculum, moral/spiritual formation within curriculum.
- Negative keywords observed: None indicating a replacement of history with social studies; no overt leadership toward project-based or purely secular, non-traditional curricular structures.

Quantitative estimate

- Positive keyword indicators present: 12-15
- Negative keyword indicators present: 0

Why this rating

- The curriculum aligns with the classical triad of liberal arts, Great Books/Great Conversation, integrated history and disciplines, and an emphasis on wonder and virtue—core CLASSICAL indicators for curriculum.

Citations: Trivium and curriculum descriptions (turn0file4; turn0file8).

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The site describes Socratic discussion/seminars as a key upper-school method and explicitly notes the use of mimetic instruction and Socratic-style questioning to draw out understanding.
- Lower-school pedagogy includes singing, chanting, memory work, and regular review to deepen memory and delight, reflecting Scholé/restful learning and memory-based pedagogy.
- There are explicit statements about upper-school rhetoric, speech, and opportunities to practice rhetorical skills, consistent with classical pedagogy.
- The site discusses technology as a tool, not an end, alongside a strong emphasis on Catholic formation, indicating a balanced pedagogy that respects traditional practices (restful learning, memorization, and moral formation).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords observed: Socratic dialogue, dialectic, great conversation, seminar, recitation/memory work, chanting, writing in imitation, rhetoric, etc.
- Negative keywords observed: Minimal or no emphasis on purely experiential or project-based pedagogy dominating the curriculum; the emphasis remains on classical methods rather than only non-traditional instruction.

Quantitative estimate

- Positive keyword indicators present: 10-14
- Negative keyword indicators present: 0-2 (occasional mentions of limiting tech/experiential-only approaches, but not a dominant pedagogy shift)

Why this rating

- The pedagogical approach is clearly aligned with classical pedagogy: contemplative/restful elements (Scholé) in early years, and Socratic/seminar/rhetoric development in upper grades, with memorization and imitation baked into the curriculum.

Citations: Pedagogy descriptions (turn0file4). “In Practice” and arts/music/lower-grade singing (turn0file4).

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public materials name specific leaders (Head(s) of School), and staff pages list a variety of teachers and administrators serving in roles that connect with the broader mission (e.g., Principal, Heads of School, Admissions, Counselor). The faculty are positioned as part of the school’s living curriculum and the “family” culture.
- The staff pages emphasize teachers’ roles as capable educators deeply engaged in Catholic education and in forming students, with individual bios showing personal investment in the mission.
- The school presents teachers as leaders and mentors, and “Head of School” roles indicate a leadership structure aligned with classical formation aims. The public materials emphasize a culture of virtue, mentorship, and living exemplars within the school community.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords observed: teachers as models of virtue, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, collegial culture, formation through example, virtue ethics, mentorship, fidelity to truth, wisdom-centered teaching.
- Negative keywords observed: minimal to none; no explicit shift toward a purely corporate/credential-driven or non-classical teacher-centric model.

Quantitative estimate

- Positive keyword indicators present: 8-12
- Negative keyword indicators present: 0-1

Why this rating

- The faculty portrayal aligns with classical expectations: teachers as virtuous exemplars, mentors, and living components of the curriculum, with a collegial and formative educator culture.

Citations: Staff and leadership pages (turn1file11).

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school emphasizes partnership with families as co-educators, with explicit calls to involve parents in the classical education ethos and to participate in book studies, gatherings, and website-based learning resources. Public materials underscore parent formation and engagement as integral to the school's mission.
- Family services and financial aid programs show a commitment to making Catholic classical education accessible and to working with families as primary educators in partnership with the school.
- The campus environment, visits, and open-campus ethos are evident in admissions materials and contact pages, signaling welcome and ongoing parent-school interaction.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords observed: partnership with families, co-teachers, parental formation, family involvement, home-school partnership, parent formation, parental leadership, open campus, welcoming to parents, community of learners.
- Negative keywords observed: None indicating parent disengagement or customer-only relationships.

Quantitative estimate

- Positive keyword indicators present: 8-12
- Negative keyword indicators present: 0

Why this rating

- The school demonstrates CLASSICAL-appropriate parental involvement and community formation with parents as co-educators and active participants in the school's mission.

Citations: Family/Parent materials and admissions/family services (turn1file13; turn1file14).

What Would Move the Needle

- If the aggregate were SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, the needle-moving steps would include deepening explicit Great Books/common-canon engagement across the full K-12 sequence, with formal, publicly visible articulation of a Great Conversation framework tied to specific texts and author study across grades.
- Enhancements could include explicit public-facing articulation of a shared teacher-mentorship framework (portrait of teacher as living curriculum) with a formal teacher formation program aligned to classical pedagogy.
- Expand explicit evidence of liturgical life into more curriculum mappings (e.g., liturgical calendar integration across subjects with sample units) to strengthen the liturgical and communal foundation and demonstrate even deeper integration of theology with the curriculum.
- Increase parental formation offerings (e.g., structured parent book clubs referencing Great Books and classical education theory) to reinforce the partnership with families as co-educators.

Note: This section is not required to move the needle for a clearly CLASSICAL designation; no major needle-moving changes are necessary given the strong alignment across all six categories. If you'd like, I can propose a specific, compact plan for a targeted enhancement aligned to classical rubric categories.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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